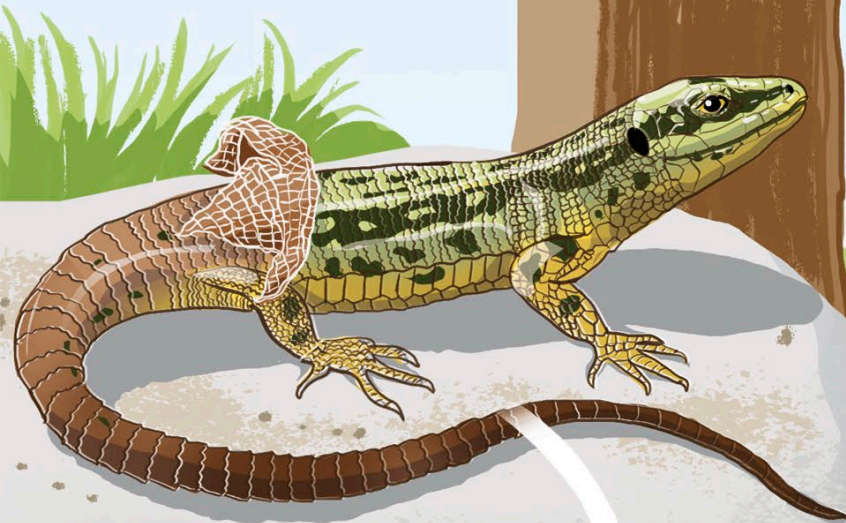


Breeding colors

In spring, as the weather begins to get warmer, viviparous lizards come out from hibernation. The males molt, shedding their skin in flakes, and develop their brighter breeding colors.



Love bites

During courtship, a male lizard grips a female with his jaws. If she accepts him, the pair mate. However, if she is not interested, she bites him fiercely and he backs off.



Lizard

Most reptiles lay eggs, but a few lizards and some snakes give birth to fully formed babies. The viviparous lizard is unusual, in that it can do both. This lizard produces live young in places where it would be too cold for eggs laid outside to survive. In warmer climates, it sometimes lays eggs.



Carrying young

The female adjusts her body temperature so that it's just right for her young to develop inside her. She basks in the sun to warm up and hides in the shade to cool down.

Saltwater crocodile The biggest reptile eggs are laid by the saltwater crocodile, which is the largest living reptile. Whether the baby crocs that hatch are male or female depends on the temperature inside the nest when the eggs are incubating.



Rubber boa Bearing live young is more common in snakes than lizards. Roughly one-fifth of all snake species give birth rather than lay eggs. This includes the rubber boa, which can have up to eight babies at a time.

